



Sofrito

C O C I N A B O R I C U A



The Kitchen Bundle

Printable tools for your first boricua kitchen week —
recipes, planner, lists, and the sofrito cheat sheet.

- 8 recipe cards, bilingual (EN / ES)
- Weekly meal planner + shopping lists
- The 1-page sofrito cheat sheet

Mofongo

Card 1 / 8

Smashed green plantain with garlic — la estrella

Serves: 4 **Time:** 45 min **Level:** Medium

INGREDIENTS

4 green plantains

4 garlic cloves

 $\frac{1}{3}$ cup olive oil $\frac{1}{4}$ cup chicharrón (optional) $\frac{1}{2}$ cup chicken broth, warm

Salt

STEPS

- 1 Peel & cut plantains into $1\frac{1}{2}$ -in rounds. Fry in oil until golden and soft.
- 2 Pound garlic + salt into a paste in a pilón or bowl.
- 3 Add plantains + chicharrón; pound while drizzling olive oil.
- 4 Add warm broth to loosen. Mold into balls or unmold from a bowl.
- 5 Drizzle with mojo de ajo. Serve hot.

EN ESPAÑOL

Fríe los plátanos verdes, machácalos con ajo, chicharrón y aceite; afloja con caldo tibio. Sirve con mojo.

KITCHEN BUNDLE • SOFRITO — COCINA BORICUA

CARD 1 / 8

Arroz con Pollo

Card 2 / 8

Yellow chicken & rice — el clásico de los domingos

Serves: 6 **Time:** 45 min **Level:** Easy **Sofrito:** 1 cube

INGREDIENTS

6 bone-in chicken thighs**1** sofrito cube**2 tsp** sazón**2 cups** medium-grain rice**3 cups** hot chicken broth**½ cup** alcaparrado**2 tbsp** olive oil • salt & pepper

STEPS

- 1 Season chicken with sazón, salt, pepper. Brown 4–5 min per side. Set aside.
- 2 Cook the sofrito cube 2 min until fragrant.
- 3 Add rice; stir to coat. Add alcaparrado.
- 4 Return chicken, pour in hot broth, bring to a boil.
- 5 Cover, low heat, 20 min without lifting.
- 6 Rest 5 min, fluff, serve.

EN ESPAÑOL

Dora el pollo con sazón. Sofríe el sofrito, saltea el arroz, vuelve a poner el pollo, añade caldo caliente y tapa a fuego bajo 20 minutos. Reposa 5 y esponja.

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CARD 2 / 8

Arroz con Gandules

Card 3 / 8

The #1 searched boricua rice — el arroz de fiesta

Serves: 8 **Time:** 45 min **Level:** Easy **Sofrito:** 1 cube

INGREDIENTS

3 cups medium-grain rice

1 can gandules, liquid reserved

1 sofrito cube

2 tsp sazón

2 tbsp alcaparrado

3 tbsp olive oil

Gandules liquid + water to 4½ cups

STEPS

- 1 Rinse & drain the rice.
- 2 Cook the sofrito cube in oil 2 min until fragrant.
- 3 Add rice, sazón, alcaparrado; stir 3 min.
- 4 Add gandules + liquid to 4½ cups total; salt.
- 5 Boil, cover, simmer low 20 min without lifting.
- 6 Rest 10 min, fluff, serve.

EN ESPAÑOL

Sofríe el sofrito, saltea el arroz con sazón, añade los gandules con su jugo y agua hasta 4½ tazas. Tapa y cocina 20 min; reposa 10.

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CARD 3 / 8

Habichuelas Guisadas

Card 4 / 8

Stewed pink beans — el acompañante eterno

Serves: 6 **Time:** 40 min **Level:** Easy **Sofrito:** 1 cube

INGREDIENTS

2 cans pink beans (or 1 lb dried, pre-cooked)

1 sofrito cube

½ cup tomato sauce

2 tsp sazón

½ cup calabaza, cubed

2 tbsp alcaparrado

3 cups water or broth • 3 tbsp oil

STEPS

- 1 Cook the sofrito cube in oil 2 min.
- 2 Add tomato sauce, sazón, alcaparrado; cook 3 min.
- 3 Add beans, calabaza and liquid; simmer 20 min uncovered.
- 4 Simmer longer for a thicker sauce; season.
- 5 Serve over arroz blanco.

EN ESPAÑOL

Sofríe el sofrito con salsa de tomate, añade las habichuelas, calabaza y agua. Hierva suave 20–25 min hasta espesar.

KITCHEN BUNDLE • SOFRITO — COCINA BORICUA

CARD 4 / 8

Tostones

Card 5 / 8

Twice-fried green plantain — el crujido perfecto

Serves: 4 **Time:** 30 min **Level:** Easy

INGREDIENTS

2 green plantains

1½ cups canola oil

Flaky salt

Mojo de ajo to serve

STEPS

- 1 Peel plantains, cut into 1-in rounds.
- 2 Fry at 350°F 3–4 min until pale gold. Drain.
- 3 Smash each round to ½ in with a tostonera or plate bottom.
- 4 Fry again 2–3 min until golden and crisp.
- 5 Salt while hot. Serve with mojo.

EN ESPAÑOL

Fríe los plátanos verdes, aplástalos y fríe de nuevo hasta dorar. Sal al momento y sirve con mojo.

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CARD 5 / 8

Amarillos (Maduros)

Card 6 / 8

Sweet ripe plantain — el dulce frito

Serves: 4 **Time:** 15 min **Level:** Easy

INGREDIENTS

2 ripe plantains, black-spotted**½ cup** canola oil

Pinch of salt

STEPS

- 1 Peel plantains, slice diagonally into ¾-in pieces.
- 2 Fry over medium 3–4 min per side until deep golden.
- 3 Drain, sprinkle with salt.
- 4 Serve with rice & beans or a fried egg on top.

EN ESPAÑOL

Fríe el plátano maduro a fuego medio hasta que acaramele. Escurre y sal al momento.

KITCHEN BUNDLE • SOFRITO — COCINA BORICUA

CARD 6 / 8

Pernil

Card 7 / 8

Slow-roasted pork shoulder — el plato de Nochebuena

Serves: 12 **Time:** 6 hrs + overnight **Level:** Easy, mostly waiting

INGREDIENTS

1 (8 lb) pork shoulder, skin scored**12** garlic cloves, minced**2 tbsp** adobo**1 tbsp** dried oregano**¼ cup** olive oil**¼ cup** distilled vinegar

STEPS

- 1 Pound garlic, adobo, oregano + oil into a paste; add vinegar.
- 2 Rub deep into scored skin and all over.
- 3 Marinate overnight in the fridge (12–24 hrs).
- 4 Roast at 300°F uncovered until fork-tender, 5–6 hrs.
- 5 Raise to 450°F for the last 15–20 min to crisp the skin.
- 6 Rest 30 min, pull, serve with arroz con gandules.

EN ESPAÑOL

Adoba el pernil con la pasta de ajo la noche antes. Asa a 300°F por 5–6 horas hasta que se deshaga. Sube el horno para tostar el cuero y descansa 30 min.

KITCHEN BUNDLE • SOFRITO — COCINA BORICUA

CARD 7 / 8

Coquito

Card 8 / 8

Puerto Rican eggnog — el brindis de la Navidad

Makes: 6 cups **Time:** 15 min + chill **Level:** Easy

INGREDIENTS

1 can coconut milk**1 can** cream of coconut**1 can** condensed milk**1 can** evaporated milk**1 tsp** vanilla • **1 tsp** cinnamon**¼ tsp** nutmeg**1½ cups** white rum (optional)

STEPS

- 1 Blend the four milks with vanilla, cinnamon, nutmeg.
- 2 Stir in rum to taste.
- 3 Chill at least 2 hrs.
- 4 Pour, dust with cinnamon, toast the family.

EN ESPAÑOL

Licúa las cuatro leches con vainilla, canela y nuez moscada. Añade el ron, enfría y sirve espolvoreado con canela.

KITCHEN BUNDLE • SOFRITO — COCINA BORICUA

CARD 8 / 8

Weekly Meal Planner

English

This week’s goal: plan 3–4 boricua nights. Every one starts with a sofrito cube. **Ideas:** arroz con pollo · habichuelas + amarillos · pollo guisado · picadillo · arroz con salchichas · mampostiao (leftover rice reborn).

Day	What we’re eating	Notes / prep
Monday		
Tuesday		
Wednesday		
Thursday		
Friday		
Saturday		
Sunday		

Sofrito cube tracker: ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ — one cube per sofrito recipe.

Planificador Semanal

Español

La meta de la semana: planifica 3–4 noches boricuas. Todas empiezan con un cubito de sofrito. **Ideas:** arroz con pollo · habichuelas + amarillos · pollo guisado · picadillo · arroz con salchichas · mampostiao (el arroz de ayer renacido).

Día	Qué comemos	Notas / prep
Lunes		
Martes		
Miércoles		
Jueves		
Viernes		
Sábado		
Domingo		

Contador de cubitos: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] — un cubito por receta con sofrito.

Shopping List

English

PRODUCE



PANTRY



MEAT & SEAFOOD



FROZEN



DAIRY & EGGS



OTHER



Tip: check the pantry first — sofrito, rice, beans, garlic, onions and oil cover most boricua dinners.

Lista de Compras

Español

VERDURAS Y FRUTAS



DESPENSA



CARNES Y MARISCOS



CONGELADOS



LÁCTEOS Y HUEVOS



OTROS



Consejo: revisa la despensa primero — sofrito, arroz, habichuelas, ajo, cebolla y aceite cubren casi toda la cocina boricua.

Sofrito Cheat Sheet

One cube, one dish — always

1 cube

PER DISH

14 cubes

PER TRAY ≈ 14 DINNERS

3 months

IN THE FREEZER

Master ratios (per ~2 cups)

- 1 bunch culantro (recao)
- 15 ajíes dulces
- 2 green + 1 red bell pepper
- 1 large onion • 1 head garlic
- ½ cup olive oil
- 2 tbsp white vinegar • 1 tbsp salt

The method in 4 moves

- Rough-chop everything.
- Pulse to coarse — not a purée.
- Stir in oil, vinegar, salt; taste.
- Jar it, or cube it and freeze.

Mainland swaps

- Culantro → 2 parts cilantro + green bell pepper
- Ají dulce → extra green bell pepper
- No annatto? → skip it, sazón adds color

Keep it green

- Pulse, rest, pulse — heat turns it brown.
- Oil cap on the jar = 3 weeks in the fridge.
- Label frozen bags with the date.
- Bitter? Seed the peppers. Flat? More garlic.

One cube rule: a single frozen cube seasons one pot of rice or guiso. Grab it straight from the freezer into the hot pan — no thawing.

THE BUNDLE

You're stocked for a boricua week.

8 recipe cards, bilingual planners and lists, and the sofrito cheat sheet — all ready to print, hang, and cook from.

The Kitchen Bundle — printables (this pack)	\$67
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+ La Mesa Boricua — full 30-recipe cookbook	\$47
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The Full Table — cookbook + weeknights system	\$97
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— *Print, cook, enjoy. ¡Pa'lante!*